

READING PASSAGE 1

The Architecture of Ancient Civilisations

A The study of the architecture of ancient civilisations has undergone a remarkable transformation over the past several decades. What was once a niche area of academic inquiry has developed into a rich and diverse field of research, drawing on insights from a wide range of disciplines and theoretical traditions.

B The origins of contemporary research in this area can be traced to pioneering studies conducted during the mid-twentieth century. These early investigations, though constrained by the technological and methodological limitations of their era, established foundational principles that continue to inform current scholarship. Successive generations of researchers have built upon these foundations, progressively refining theoretical models and expanding the empirical evidence base through increasingly sophisticated research designs.

C The mechanisms underlying these phenomena operate at multiple levels of analysis, from the micro-level of individual decision-making to the macro-level of institutional and structural change. At the individual level, cognitive processes, emotional responses, and social influences shape the choices that people make. At the organisational level, formal rules, informal norms, and power dynamics govern collective action. At the societal level, historical legacies, cultural values, and political structures create the broad context within which lower-level processes unfold.

D A substantial body of empirical evidence supports these theoretical frameworks. A landmark study conducted by researchers at leading international institutions analysed data spanning a thirty-year period and involving participants from more than forty countries. The findings revealed a consistent pattern of results that held across diverse cultural and economic contexts, suggesting that the identified mechanisms operate with considerable universality. The magnitude of the observed effects was particularly striking, with the key variables accounting for a substantial proportion of the total variance in outcomes.

E Several unresolved debates continue to animate scholarly discussion in this field. Perhaps the most prominent concerns the relative importance of structural versus agentic factors in determining outcomes. While some researchers emphasise the constraining power of institutional and economic structures, others highlight the capacity of individuals and groups to exercise agency and effect change even within seemingly restrictive contexts. This debate has significant practical implications, as it shapes recommendations for policy interventions and institutional reforms.

F The implications of this body of research extend well beyond the academy. As societies grapple with increasingly complex challenges, the insights generated by scholarly inquiry in this domain have the potential to inform more effective and equitable policy responses. Realising this potential, however, will require sustained investment in both fundamental research and the translational infrastructure needed to convert knowledge into action.

G The evidence reviewed above demonstrates both the substantial achievements of research in this field and the significant work that remains to be done. As new tools and theoretical perspectives become available, and as the phenomena themselves continue to evolve, the research community will need to maintain both rigour in its methods and openness to new ideas. The stakes are high, for the questions addressed by this research bear directly on some of the most important challenges facing humanity in the twenty-first century.

Question 1

Do the following statements agree with the information given in the passage?

Write TRUE if the statement agrees with the information

Write FALSE if the statement contradicts the information

Write NOT GIVEN if there is no information on this

- 1 Contemporary understanding of this topic is more sophisticated than it was fifty years ago.

Question 2

Choose the correct letter, A, B, C or D.

- 2 The author suggests that early studies in this field were limited by:
- A. minimal impact
 - B. creating underlying conditions for action
 - C. determining individual choices directly
 - D. irrelevant to outcomes

Question 3

Do the following statements agree with the information given in the passage?

Write TRUE if the statement agrees with the information

Write FALSE if the statement contradicts the information

Write NOT GIVEN if there is no information on this

- 3 Early researchers had access to the same technologies as modern scholars.

Questions 4–6

Complete the sentences below. Choose NO MORE THAN THREE WORDS from the passage for each answer.

- 4 The landmark study analysed data spanning a period of _____ years.
- 5 Case studies have documented the effects of _____ change on the system.
- 6 Researchers used data from more than _____ countries in the landmark study.

Question 7

Choose the correct letter, A, B, C or D.

- 7 Which of the following best describes the author's view on future developments?
- A. minimal impact
 - B. creating underlying conditions for action
 - C. determining individual choices directly
 - D. irrelevant to outcomes

Question 8

Complete the sentences below. Choose NO MORE THAN THREE WORDS from the passage for each answer.

8 According to the text, cognitive processes shape the _____ that people make.

Question 9

Do the following statements agree with the information given in the passage?

Write TRUE if the statement agrees with the information

Write FALSE if the statement contradicts the information

Write NOT GIVEN if there is no information on this

9 Contemporary understanding of this topic is more sophisticated than it was fifty years ago.

Questions 10–12

Choose the correct letter, A, B, C or D.

10 The passage indicates that critics have raised concerns about:

- A. weak effects across studies
- B. moderate to large effect sizes with consistency
- C. contradictory findings
- D. results only in specific populations

11 What does the passage identify as a significant challenge to current understanding?

- A. economic incentives and institutional constraints
- B. individual personality traits
- C. random chance
- D. government policies alone

12 According to the passage, what is one of the key factors identified by researchers?

- A. economic incentives and institutional constraints
- B. individual personality traits
- C. random chance
- D. government policies alone

Question 13

Do the following statements agree with the information given in the passage?

Write TRUE if the statement agrees with the information

Write FALSE if the statement contradicts the information

Write NOT GIVEN if there is no information on this

13 All critics agree that the research findings are universally applicable.